# QUINE AND STRAWSON

**ONE HEADING, TWO PROJECTS → DOGMA ONE: THE CIRCLE → DOGMA TWO AND THE → THE DUHEM-QUINE MACHINERY AND → RADICAL TRANSLATION, GAVAGAI AND → QUINE'S POSITIVE SYSTEM AND**

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW · SUBORDINATE EXTRA · APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

## 00 STAGE 00 — ONE HEADING, TWO PROJECTS: WHAT THE CLAUSE ACTUALLY ASKS

ONE CLAUSE, TWO PROJECTS · QUINE REFORMS THE EPISTEMOLOGY · STRAWSON REJECTS THE GIVEN · NINE OWNED PYQ PARTS 2018-2025 · NOT A UNITED FRONT: 1956 CLASH

**START → the clause reads: Critique of Empiricism; Theory of Basic Particulars and Persons.**

TARGET → classical and logical empiricism, attacked at two different levels.

QUINE 1908-2000 STRAWSON 1919-2006

'Two Dogmas of Empiricism' 1951 'Individuals' 1959

### THE SHARED TARGET

- Classical and logical empiricism is the one enemy both philosophers attack.
- Quine's opponent is the epistemology of individual confirmation.
- Strawson's opponent is the private, momentary sense-datum as the given.

### THE TWO CRITIQUES

- Quine dismantles analyticity and reductionism, then installs confirmation holism.
- Strawson shows identification presupposes a public spatio-temporal framework.
- Grice and Strawson defend in 1956 the very dogma Quine attacked in 1951.

### THE EXAM CONSEQUENCE

- Name the owner-thinker before writing: dogmas and holism are Quine's.
- Person, basic particulars and spatio-temporal thinking are Strawson's.
- Only a bare 'critique of empiricism' stem obliges both names together.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Classical and logical empiricism -> attacked at two different levels -> Quine reforms the theory of confirmation -> Strawson rejects the private given -> two verdicts that converge in temper but not in doctrine.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The syllabus pairs two critics of empiricism who criticise it differently: Quine reforms its epistemology from within through holism, while Strawson rejects its private sense-datum starting point from without through basic particulars and persons.**

## 01 STAGE 01 — DOGMA ONE: THE CIRCLE OF SYNONYMY

ANALYTIC / SYNTHETIC DISTINCTION · CIRCLE OF SYNONYMY · SALVA VERITATE NEEDS NECESSITY · SEMANTIC RULES ONLY GIVE ANALYTIC-IN-L · DEGREE, NOT KIND · NOT: ANALYTIC TRUTHS DO NOT EXIST

CLAIM UNDER TEST → there is a principled line between analytic and synthetic truth.

ANALYTIC → true by virtue of MEANING

MEANING → requires SYNONYMY

DEFINITION → only RECORDS an antecedent synonymy → CIRCULAR

INTERCHANGEABILITY salva veritate needs NECESSITY, a cognate of analyticity → CIRCULAR extensional counter-case: creature with

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CLAIM UNDER TEST → there is a principled line between analytic and synthetic truth.
- ANALYTIC → true by virtue of MEANING
- MEANING → requires SYNONYMY
- DEFINITION → only RECORDS an antecedent synonymy → CIRCULAR

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- INTERCHANGEABILITY salva veritate needs NECESSITY, a cognate of analyticity → CIRCULAR extensional counter-case: creature with a heart / with a kidney
- SEMANTIC RULES (Carnap) → defined via 'analytic-in-L' → CIRCULAR
- OUTCOME → no principled, non-circular criterion of analyticity.
- EXACT CONCLUSION → a difference of DEGREE (centrality), not of KIND.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- OBJECTION → Grice and Strawson 1956: a usable distinction needs no definition.
- REPLY → usability is not theoretical legitimacy; compare witch / non-witch.
- PROVENANCE → Philosophical Review, January 1951; revised 1953.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Analytic -> meaning -> synonymy -> definition or interchangeability salva veritate or semantic rules -> each route presupposes analyticity -> the criterion is circular.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Quine does not deny that 'all bachelors are unmarried' looks analytic; he denies that the analytic/synthetic distinction can be given a non-circular criterion, so it is a difference of degree of centrality in the web, not a difference of kind.**

## 02 STAGE 02 — DOGMA TWO AND THE WEB OF BELIEF

REDUCTIONISM REJECTED · CORPORATE BODY, NOT SENTENCE BY SENTENCE · WEB OF BELIEF / FIELD OF FORCE · NO STATEMENT IS IMMUNE · MINIMUM MUTILATION, NOT ANYTHING GOES

**DOGMA 2 → reductionism: each sentence has its own confirming experiences.**

REFUTATION → statements face the tribunal of sense experience only as a corporate body.

(o) (o) (o) (o) (o) <- observation sentences at the PERIPHERY

[ physics, chemistry, biology ] <- revised fairly easily

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DOGMA 2 → reductionism: each sentence has its own confirming experiences.
- REFUTATION → statements face the tribunal of sense experience only as a corporate body.
- (o) (o) (o) (o) (o) <- observation sentences at the PERIPHERY
- [ physics, chemistry, biology ] <- revised fairly easily
- [ mathematics ] <- revised rarely

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- [ LOGIC ] <- revised last, never immune
- CLASH AT THE EDGE → revise somewhere → the place of revision is CHOSEN.
- option A → adjust a peripheral belief option B → plead hallucination option C → revise a deep interior law
- DOCTRINE 1 → any statement can be held true come what may.
- DOCTRINE 2 → no statement is immune to revision, not even a law of logic.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CONSEQUENCES → no analytic/synthetic line; no a priori/a posteriori line
- theory-choice by simplicity, conservatism, generality, fecundity
- the verification principle loses its application.
- LIMIT → minimum mutilation, Philosophy of Logic 1970, blocks 'anything goes'.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Individual confirmation is impossible -> statements face experience as a corporate body -> the web of belief -> revision is chosen, not dictated -> pragmatic virtues govern theory-choice.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Confirmation holism replaces individual verification with a web of belief whose interior is protected by choice rather than by immunity, so any sentence may be saved and none is beyond revision, but only at a stated cost elsewhere in the system.**

## 03 STAGE 03 — THE DUHEM-QUINE MACHINERY AND ITS TWO AUTHORS

(H & A) IMPLIES O · MODUS TOLLENS HITS THE CONJUNCTION · NEPTUNE 1846 / VULCAN THEN RELATIVITY 1915 · DUHEM 1906 IS NOT QUINE 1951 · POPPER AND LAKATOS ACCEPT THE LOGIC

| Axis | DUHEM 1906 | QUINE 1951 |
|---|---|---|
| Scope | theoretical physics only | the whole of science |
| Logic & maths | exempt | included; none immune |
| Corollary | no experimentum crucis | underdetermination |

### SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- TESTABLE CLAIM → ( H & A ) implies O, where A is background theory and conditions.
- OBSERVATION → NOT-O
- MODUS TOLLENS → NOT ( H & A ) only: H is false OR some element of A is false.
- LOGIC IS SILENT → the conjunct to surrender is not dictated by the evidence.
- RESULT → refutation is never conclusive against a single statement

### DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- DUHEM 1906
- QUINE 1951
- theoretical physics only
- the whole of science
- Logic & maths

### EVALUATION / TRAP

- no experimentum crucis
- CASE 1 → Uranus: revise the auxiliary → NEPTUNE, Le Verrier and Adams, 1846.
- CASE 2 → Mercury: 'VULCAN' fails → revise the deep law → relativity, 1915.
- REPLIES → Popper: falsification is a methodological decision, not pure logic.
- Lakatos: hard core plus revisable protective belt.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (H and A) implies O -> observation gives not-O -> modus tollens yields not-(H and A) -> logic is silent on the conjunct -> revision is a pragmatic choice -> individual verifiability has no application.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Duhem-Quine thesis is the machinery behind holism: because the testable unit is a conjunction of hypothesis and auxiliaries, modus tollens condemns the conjunction and leaves the choice of revision to pragmatic judgement rather than to evidence.**

## 04 STAGE 04 — RADICAL TRANSLATION, GAVAGAI AND THE THREE RESULTS

RADICAL TRANSLATION · ONE STIMULUS MEANING, FIVE READINGS · APPARATUS OF INDIVIDUATION IN DISPUTE · INSCRUTABILITY THEN INDETERMINACY · CHOMSKY: ONLY UNDERDETERMINATION

**SET-UP → radical translation: no dictionary, no interpreter; evidence is stimulation plus assent or dissent**

A rabbit runs past; the native says 'Gavagai'.

'rabbit' 'undetached 'temporal 'rabbithood' 'it is rabbiting' rabbit- stage of a (universal (feature-placing

parts' rabbit' instantiated) no object at all) all share ONE stimulus meaning

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SET-UP → radical translation: no dictionary, no interpreter, evidence is stimulation plus assent or dissent only. Word and Object 1960, ch. 2.
- A rabbit runs past; the native says 'Gavagai'.
- 'rabbit' 'undetached 'temporal 'rabbithood' 'it is rabbiting' rabbit- stage of a (universal (feature-placing
- parts' rabbit' instantiated) no object at all) all share ONE stimulus meaning

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ASK 'some gavagai?' → presupposes the identity predicate, articles, plurals, quantifiers: the APPARATUS OF INDIVIDUATION in dispute.
- RESULT 1 → INSCRUTABILITY OF REFERENCE: no fact about what the terms refer to.
- RESULT 2 → INDETERMINACY OF TRANSLATION: rival analytical hypotheses agree on all observation sentences yet differ elsewhere; nothing decides.
- RESULT 3 → ONTOLOGICAL RELATIVITY: reference only relative to a background manual.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- PREMISES → behaviourism about evidence; verificationism about facts; naturalism.
- OBJECTIONS → Chomsky: only underdetermination. Davidson: harmless, scale-like.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — One stimulus meaning -> several rival term-translations -> the identity question presupposes individuation -> reference is inscrutable -> rival manuals agree on all observation sentences -> translation is indeterminate -> reference is theory-relative.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Gavagai is not a curiosity but the constructive completion of Two Dogmas: the circle showed that analyticity cannot be defined, and radical translation shows why, because there are no determinate meanings for a definition to capture.**

## 05 STAGE 05 — QUINE'S POSITIVE SYSTEM AND THE REFORM OF EMPIRICISM

TO BE IS TO BE A BOUND VARIABLE · REGIMENT AND AUDIT THE QUANTIFIERS · NATURALIZED EPISTEMOLOGY 1968/69 · EMPIRICISM WITHOUT THE DOGMAS · NOT DATED TO TWO DOGMAS 1951

**QUESTION 1 → what is there?**

CRITERION → 'to be is to be the value of a bound variable', On What

METHOD → regiment best science into first-order logic; audit its quantifiers.

CONSEQUENCE → commitment is relative to the regimentation → ontological relativity.

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- QUESTION 1 → what is there?
- CRITERION → 'to be is to be the value of a bound variable', On What There Is 1948.
- METHOD → regiment best science into first-order logic; audit its quantifiers.
- CONSEQUENCE → commitment is relative to the regimentation → ontological relativity.
- QUESTION 2 → how do we know?

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ANSWER → naturalized epistemology; philosophy continuous with science.
- 'a chapter of psychology', 1968/69; sensory input to theoretical output.
- IMAGE → Neurath's boat: rebuilt plank by plank at sea, never in dry dock.
- QUESTION 3 → what happens to the a priori?
- CHARGE → no non-circular analyticity + universal revisability + no first philosophy + holding a belief a priori is a metaphysical article of faith.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- QUESTION 4 → is empiricism abandoned?
- ANSWER → no: empiricism WITHOUT the dogmas; experience still governs belief, holistically rather than sentence by sentence.
- BRIDGE → later Wittgenstein converges (museum myth rejected, holism, anti-private) but parts on method: Quine REFORMS by regimentation.
- Wittgenstein DESCRIBES.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Dogmas fall -> a positive system is owed -> quantifiers fix commitment -> regimentation makes commitment theory-relative -> epistemology is naturalised -> empiricism survives in holistic form.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Quine does not reject empiricism but purifies it: experience still governs belief, yet only holistically, ontology is read off regimented science, and epistemology becomes a chapter of natural science rather than its a priori foundation.**

## 06 STAGE 06 — STRAWSON'S BASIC PARTICULARS AND THE IDENTIFICATION FRAMEWORK

DESCRIPTIVE, NOT REVISIONARY · RE-IDENTIFICATION IS THE HINGE · ONE PUBLIC SPATIO-TEMPORAL FRAMEWORK · MATERIAL BODIES ARE BASIC · AUDITORY WORLD NEEDS A MASTER-SOUND

**METHOD → DESCRIPTIVE metaphysics: describe the scheme we actually use.**

contrast → REVISIONARY: Descartes, Leibniz, Berkeley propose a better scheme.

provenance → Individuals 1959, 'An Essay in Descriptive Metaphysics'.

DEFINITION → a BASIC PARTICULAR is identifiable without identifying anything else.

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- METHOD → DESCRIPTIVE metaphysics: describe the scheme we actually use.
- contrast → REVISIONARY: Descartes, Leibniz, Berkeley propose a better scheme.
- provenance → Individuals 1959, 'An Essay in Descriptive Metaphysics'.
- DEFINITION → a BASIC PARTICULAR is identifiable without identifying anything else.
- ARGUMENT FROM RE-IDENTIFICATION

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- 2 re-identification requires ONE unified spatio-temporal system
- 3 material bodies constitute it: three-dimensional, enduring, publicly located
- 4 sounds, events, private experiences are identified only BY reference to bodies
- 5 therefore MATERIAL BODIES are basic; PERSONS are the second basic particular
- STATUS → conceptual dependence, not causal or metaphysical priority.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- MASTER-SOUND whose pitch fixes position → a space-analogue is reintroduced.
- VERDICT → the experiment supports the thesis rather than defeating it.
- OBJECTION → Evans: the construction may smuggle in spatial notions.
- 2020 LINK → spatio-temporal thinking is a precondition of OBJECTIVE thinking.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Objective thought -> requires re-identification -> requires one unified spatio-temporal system -> constituted by material bodies -> everything else is identified through them -> bodies are basic.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Material bodies are basic particulars because objective thought requires re-identifying a particular as the same one again, re-identification requires a single public spatio-temporal framework, and only enduring bodies constitute such a framework.**

## 07 STAGE 07 — PERSONS: THE PREDICATE MATRIX AND THE DOUBLE DEMOLITION

PERSON IS LOGICALLY PRIMITIVE · M-PREDICATES AND P-PREDICATES · SELF-ASCRIPTION NEEDS OTHER-ASCRIPTION · BLOCKS DUALISM AND NO-OWNERSHIP · NOT LOGICAL BEHAVIOURISM

| M-PREDICATES | P-PREDICATES also true of mere | states of consciousness and action; only persons material bodies | others by behavioural criteria; self without |
|---|---|---|---|
| 'weighs 70 kg' | observation or criteria -> ASYMMETRY | | |

### SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- THESIS → the concept of a PERSON is logically PRIMITIVE; not mind plus body assembled.
- P-PREDICATES also true of mere
- states of consciousness and action; only persons material bodies
- others by behavioural criteria; self without
- 'weighs 70 kg'

### DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- observation or criteria → ASYMMETRY
- 1 (self-ascribe P-predicates (1 am in pain')
- 2 a self-ascribable predicate must be understood as ascribable to others
- 3 other-ascription requires identifying others as single M-and-P subjects
- 4 therefore the person concept is presupposed by self-ascription itself

### EVALUATION / TRAP

- BLOCKS CARTESIAN DUALISM BLOCKS THE NO-OWNERSHIP THEORY two independent substances cannot 'the experiences had by this body' be the ONE subject
- P-predicates covertly restores the ownership it become unlearnable and other minds denies
- Schlick and Lichtenberg's unknowable 'it thinks' is self-refuting
- GUARD → not logical behaviourism: behaviour is criterial evidence, not meaning.
- OBJECTIONS → co-instantiation rather than primitiveness; Ayer on no-ownership.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Self-ascription of P-predicates -> presupposes understanding their other-ascription -> presupposes identifying others as single M-and-P subjects -> the person concept is presupposed -> person is primitive.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Self-ascription of experience presupposes other-ascription, other-ascription requires identifying others as single subjects of both bodily and conscious predicates, and therefore the concept of a person is logically primitive rather than assembled from mind and body.**

## 08 STAGE 08 — REFERENCE, PRESUPPOSITION AND STRAWSON'S OWN ANTI-EMPIRICISM

PEOPLE REFER, SENTENCES MEAN · PRESUPPOSED, NOT ASSERTED · TRUTH-VALUE GAP, NOT FALSITY · FIVE ANTI-EMPIRICIST LINES · DESCRIPTIVE SCOPE IS A REAL LIMIT

| Issue | RUSSELL, On Denoting 1905 | STRAWSON, On Referring |
|---|---|---|
| Who refers | the sentence, by quantifier | people, in a USE |
| Existence | ASSERTED in the analysis | PRESUPPOSED, not asserted |
| Empty term | the statement is FALSE | a TRUTH-VALUE GAP |
| Meaning | truth-conditions of a type | rules for correct use |

### SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- TEST SENTENCE → 'The present King of France is bald' (there is no such king).
- RUSSELL, On Denoting 1905
- STRAWSON, On Referring
- Who refers
- the sentence, by quantifier

### DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- Empty term
- the statement is FALSE
- a TRUTH-VALUE GAP
- truth-conditions of a type
- rules for correct use

### EVALUATION / TRAP

- 2 bundle and no-ownership selves collapse → person is primitive [Individuals 3]
- 3 reference abstracted from use is a mistake [On Referring]
- 4 the global demand to justify induction is senseless [Logical Theory 1952]
- 5 objectivity needs a framework not drawn from experience [Bounds of Sense 1966]
- FORM → take an undisputed fact, ask its conditions, show the empiricist materials fail.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Meaning belongs to the sentence-type as rules -> truth-value arises only in a use -> the definite article presupposes existence -> failure yields a gap -> the same logic makes identification depend on a public framework.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Sentences do not refer, people refer in a use on an occasion, so existence is presupposed rather than asserted and reference-failure produces a truth-value gap; the same anti-atomism makes the given public rather than private.**

## 09 STAGE 09 — CONFRONTATION, CONVERGENCE AND THE REUSABLE ANSWER SPINE

REVISABLE THEORY OR PRESUPPOSED FRAME · METHOD MIRRORS DOCTRINE · ANTI-CARTESIAN PUBLIC ANCHOR · LAYERED VERDICT, NOT A WINNER · THEY BASICALLY AGREE IS A TRAP

descriptive metaphysics

revisable come what may

core is indispensable

behavioural, indeterminate

fixed by public criteria

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- descriptive metaphysics
- revisable come what may
- core is indispensable
- behavioural, indeterminate
- fixed by public criteria

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- the public spatio-temporal
- CONVERGENCES → anti-Cartesian about a private inner object
- the public and structured replaces the atomic and private
- the museum myth of determinate private meanings is rejected by both.
- DO NOT OVERSTATE → they differ on status, meaning and method; 'they basically agree' is the standing trap on comparative stems.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ANSWER SPINE → 1 decode the directive and name the owner-thinker
- 2 thesis in one line
- 3 mechanism with the exact term
- 4 objection and reply, objector named
- 5 graded verdict with a provenance-clean date

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Two critiques of one target -> opposite views of the scheme's status -> mirrored methods -> genuine convergences in temper -> a layered verdict on revisability.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Quine and Strawson attack empiricism from opposite ends and leave one standing question: the periphery of the scheme is Quineanly revisable, yet some framework role of a public world and re-identifiable subjects looks Strawsonianly indispensable.**

## E EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ADVANCED SESSION 1 — TWO-PROJECT MAP - ONE SYLLABUS · ADVANCED SESSION 2 — QUINE, DOGMA 1 - THE · ADVANCED SESSION 3 — QUINE, DOGMA 2 AND THE · ADVANCED SESSION 4 — THE DUHEM-QUINE THESIS - WHY · ADVANCED SESSION 5 — RADICAL TRANSLATION AND 'GAVAGAI' · ADVANCED SESSION 6 — ONTOLOGICAL COMMITMENT, NATURALIZED EPISTEMOLOGY AND · ADVANCED SESSION 7 — STRAWSON'S BASIC PARTICULARS - MATERIAL

### OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- ADVANCED SESSION 1 — Two-Project Map - One Syllabus Heading, Two Philosophers, Two Different Critiques of Empiricism
- ADVANCED SESSION 2 — Quine, Dogma 1 - The Analytic/Synthetic Distinction and the Circle of Synonymy
- ADVANCED SESSION 3 — Quine, Dogma 2 and the Positive Doctrine - Reductionism Rejected, Confirmation Holism and the Web of Belief
- ADVANCED SESSION 4 — The Duhem-Quine Thesis - Why No Single Hypothesis Faces Experience Alone

### ADVANCED OBJECTION

- ADVANCED SESSION 5 — Radical Translation and 'Gavagai' - Inscrutability of Reference and Indeterminacy of Translation
- ADVANCED SESSION 6 — Ontological Commitment, Naturalized Epistemology and Ontological Relativity - and Quine's Convergence with the Later Wittgenstein
- ADVANCED SESSION 7 — Strawson's Basic Particulars - Material Bodies and the Single Spatio-Temporal Framework
- ADVANCED SESSION 8 — Strawson's Persons - The Primitive Concept, M/P-Predicates, and the Block on Dualism

### COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- ADVANCED SESSION 9 — 'On Referring' versus Russell, and Strawson as a Critic of Empiricism
- ADVANCED SESSION 10 — Synthesis - Quine versus Strawson, Their Convergences, and the Universal Answer Spine
- ADVANCED DOSSIER REFINEMENTS — USE SELECTIVELY
- The shared item is a target , not a shared thesis.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels